

U.S. SEMICONDUCTOR: TRADE & LABOR ANALYSIS

State & Metro Area Employment (SAE) — BLS Tables | 2025 Q3

Overview

This document logs the State and Metro Area Employment, Hours, & Earnings (SAE) tables downloaded from the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics to support regional employment analysis. The SAE program provides monthly employment data across states, metropolitan areas, and industry sectors, enabling both seasonally adjusted and raw comparisons for detailed geographic and sectoral insights.

All tables were obtained in XLSX and PDF formats as published by the BLS. Both seasonally adjusted and not seasonally adjusted series were collected to support trend analysis, over-the-month comparisons, and regional targeting across U.S. labor markets.

Source & Release Information

Attribute	Value
Data provider	U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS)
Publication	State and Metro Area Employment, Hours, & Earnings (SAE)
Release	Q3 2025 (latest available at time of collection)
Format	XLSX and PDF tables (as published by BLS)
Adjustment types	Seasonally adjusted (SA) and Not seasonally adjusted (NSA)

Tables Downloaded

Table	Adjustment	Title	Analytical Purpose
Table 2	Metro-Level	Employees on nonfarm payrolls by state, selected metropolitan areas, and metropolitan divisions	Metro-level employment comparisons across geographic regions and urban labor markets
Table 3	Seasonally Adjusted	Employees on nonfarm payrolls by state and selected industry sector	Clean comparisons across states and industries, removing seasonal fluctuations
Table 4	Not Seasonally Adjusted	Employees on nonfarm payrolls by state and selected industry sector	Raw employment counts for over-the-month and over-the-year change calculations

Rationale for Table Selection

Table 2: Metro-Level Granularity

Table 2 adds metro-level granularity to the analysis, supporting urban labor market comparisons and regional targeting. Metropolitan area data is critical for semiconductor cluster analysis, where fab locations and engineering talent pools are concentrated in specific metro regions such as Phoenix, Austin, and Portland.

Table 3: Seasonally Adjusted State Employment

Table 3 provides seasonally adjusted employment data, ideal for trend analysis and policy modeling. Removing seasonal fluctuations allows for cleaner quarter-over-quarter comparisons across states and industries, making it the primary reference for tracking labor market dynamics over time.

Table 4: Not Seasonally Adjusted Raw Counts

Table 4 provides raw employment counts suitable for calculating over-the-month and over-the-year changes. These unadjusted figures are used for direct benchmarking and economic storytelling, particularly when comparing state-level employment levels at a single point in time.

How These Tables Fit the Broader Analysis

Connection to ECI Compensation Data

The SAE tables complement the Employment Cost Index dataset by providing employment counts at the state and metro level. Where the ECI shows how fast the cost of labor is rising, the SAE shows where workers are employed — enabling a combined view of labor cost pressure by geography.

Connection to Semiconductor Trade Analysis

Regional employment concentration in semiconductor-adjacent industries — including computer and electronic product manufacturing — is a critical input for nearshoring viability assessments. SAE data identifies where relevant labor pools currently exist and how they have evolved over time.

Connection to QCEW Employment and Wage Data

SAE state and metro employment series align with QCEW area-level employment counts, allowing cross-validation between the two datasets and enabling consistent regional aggregations for labor cost modeling.

Key Design Choices

- Both SA and NSA series collected: Seasonally adjusted tables (3) support trend analysis. Not seasonally adjusted tables (2, 4) are used for point-in-time regional comparisons and change calculations.
- XLSX and PDF formats retained: Tables were obtained in both formats to support machine-readable data extraction and visual verification against the official BLS layout.
- Q3 2025 as anchor period: The Q3 2025 release was the latest available at the time of data collection, providing the most current regional snapshot for 2025 analysis.
- Three tables selected: Coverage spans metro-level, state-level seasonally adjusted, and state-level unadjusted data — providing comprehensive geographic and temporal flexibility without redundancy.

Data Source

[U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics — State and Metro Area Employment, Hours, & Earnings \(SAE\)](#)